

I'm confused on why AI-related companies don't recycle water?

Posted by u/S0nic05 • 0 points • 39 comments

I was reading [this article](<https://www.unep.org/news-and-stories/story/ai-has-environmental-problem-heres-what-world-can-do-about>) published by UNEP almost a year ago and I read this paragraph:

Globally, AI-related infrastructure may soon consume six times more water than Denmark, a country of 6 million, according to one estimate. That is a problem when a quarter of humanity already lacks access to clean water and sanitation.

And I got really confused on why AI-related companies don't recycle water? From what I know (and this could be really wrong, I'm here to learn more about this), they use water to cool down electrical components. But why do they use that water one time only? I mean everyone who has a water-cooled PC has just a tank of water and that's it, they don't use new water for every cycle the water does. Why replacing it? It's not going to be drank so it can't be for health reasons, right?

I genuinely don't know why they use so much water.
(Also sorry if you find any grammatical error, I can't speak good english.)

Comments

u/gigaflops_ • 1 points • 2025-07-23 10:34 UTC

All water used for *anything* on earth is recycled- it's called the "water cycle" and it's driven entirely by the sun (i.e. *solar energy*) in a green, infinitely renewable process.

People who cry about ChatGPT wasting water don't know what they're talking about.

u/Nearby-Walk-8883 • 1 points • 2025-07-23 18:31 UTC

But what about drought areas?

u/Nearby-Walk-8883 • 1 points • 2025-07-21 23:19 UTC

I also find it convenient how there is a goal of building more Data Warehouses (even around the world, such as with Anthropic) and yet there is also a real estate shortage (causing every government to scramble to build more affordable homes). Idk man.

u/Taziar43 • 2 points • 2025-07-22 03:33 UTC

There is not a real estate shortage in the world, or in the US.

There are real estate shortages in specific areas, which makes land there expensive. That is not where they are building datacenters.

There is plenty of land to build affordable housing, just don't expect it to be in NYC, San Francisco or LA.

u/Nearby-Walk-8883 • 1 points • 2025-07-22 14:21 UTC

True, but I still see it as a little ironic 🤖